

Positive Question Tags



Question tags are used when asking for agreement or confirmation.

a **negative statement** + a **positive question tag**

Negative Statement

Positive Tag

You	aren't	a teacher,	are you?
He	isn't	crazy,	is he?
He	wasn't	relaxed,	was he?
They	weren't	late,	were they?
You	don't	French,	do you?
You	didn't	study for the test,	did you?
You	haven't	been here all week,	have you?
You	hadn't	done it before then,	had you?
You	won't	fail the exam,	will you?
You	can't	drive a car,	can you?
You	couldn't	do it for me,	could you?
We	mustn't	say anything,	must we?
You	shouldn't	be so busy,	should you?
You	wouldn't	stop me,	would you?

Statements using *barely*, *hardly*, *neither*, *no*, *nobody*, *none*, *nothing* and *seldom* are treated as negative statements.

<u>Nobody</u>	went	to the meeting,	did they?
<u>Nothing</u>	is	ready,	is it?

Question Tags

1. **Question tags** are short questions put at the end of a statement. We use them, not to ask for information, but for confirmation of or agreement to our statement.

He can drive, **can't he?**

2. We form question tags with an auxiliary verb and a personal pronoun (I, you, he, it etc). A question tag has the same auxiliary verb as in the statement. If there is no auxiliary verb in the statement, we use **do**, **does** or **did** accordingly.

She **is** sleeping, **isn't she?**

He **came** too late, **didn't he?**

3. A **positive** statement is followed by a **negative** question tag, and a **negative** statement by a **positive** question tag.

He **likes** apples, **doesn't he?**

She **doesn't** like apples, **does she?**

He **never** complains, **does he?**

4. If we **are sure** of what we are asking and we don't expect an answer, the **voice goes down** (falling intonation). If we **are not sure** and we expect an answer, the **voice goes up** (rising intonation).



She is ugly, **isn't she?** (sure)

She is a journalist, **isn't she?** (not sure)

Study the following question tags.

- | | |
|----------------------------------|--|
| 1. "I am" | "aren't I?" |
| 2. "I used to" | "didn't I?" |
| 3. Imperative | "will / won't you /
can you / could you?" |
| 4. "Let's" | "shall we?" |
| 5. "Let me/him" etc | "will / won't you?" |
| 6. "I have" (= possess) | "haven't I?" |
| 7. "I have" (used idiomatically) | "don't /
doesn't / didn't I?" |
| 8. "There is/are" | "isn't /aren't there?" |

I am tall, **aren't I?**

He **used to** drive to work, **didn't he?**

Please **help** me, **will you / can you/could you?**

Don't take all the money, **will you?**

Let's make a snowman, **shall we?**

Let him come with us, **will you / won't you?**

He **has** a pen, **hasn't he?**

He **had** an accident last week, **didn't he?**

He **has** lunch at 12.00, **doesn't he?**

There's no one here, **is there?**

There are a few oranges, **aren't there?**